

Safe Motherhood

You link mothers to antenatal care, support emergency deliveries when there is no other choice, and refer early.

For health workers

Key messages

- Know every pregnant woman in your catchment and encourage early antenatal visits.
- Help each family make a birth plan: where to deliver, transport, who will go with her, and what to bring.
- Check for danger signs at every home visit and refer without delay.
- Assist an emergency delivery only when a facility cannot be reached, then refer mother and baby.
- Follow up after the birth: mother, baby, breastfeeding, immunisation, and family planning counselling.

Refer immediately if she has

- Heavy bleeding before, during or after birth
- Severe headache, blurred vision or fits
- Fever or foul-smelling discharge
- Reduced or no baby movement
- Early rupture of membranes without labour
- Prolonged labour

Run a village session

1. Meet in a shaded, central place at a time when families can come. Greet everyone and say what today's topic is.
2. Ask what people already know and what they have heard. Listen first.
3. Share three key messages from this page in your local language. Use pictures and real examples from the village.
4. Ask people to say the messages back in their own words, and answer questions.
5. Agree on one action the village will take this month. Refer anyone who is unwell,

and record who came.

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines.